

Speed of Doing Business: Andhra Pradesh's New Efficiency Code

Early into our Government's term in 2024, it all started with a Zoom call with Aditya Mittal, CEO of Arcelor Mittal group. We discussed what would become one of the most consequential private sector industrial investments in India's recent history – a 24 million tonnes per annum greenfield steel plant in Andhra Pradesh.

The commitment we made was simple and unequivocal: land and all statutory approvals would be delivered with speed, certainty, and integrity. What followed has since become a defining example of our governance philosophy. In a little over five months, about 3,000 acres of contiguous land were handed over to ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel (AM/NS) – an outcome that would have seemed improbable not too long ago, but which is now becoming routine in Andhra Pradesh.

This is the essence of what we call the

“Speed of Doing Business.” In a world where capital is mobile and decisions are made in real time, speed is no longer a convenience – it is a competitive advantage. Global supply chains are being redrawn. Tariff barriers are rising, geopolitical risks are reshaping trade flows, and businesses are rethinking where they manufacture, innovate, and invest. In this rapidly changing landscape, what investors value most is not lofty promises, but the ability of governments to act decisively and deliver on time.

Andhra Pradesh has consciously aligned itself with this new reality. In just 18 months, we have attracted investment commitments of over ₹11 lakh crore. In 2025, our state emerged as India's most attractive investment destination, accounting for more than 25.3% of all proposed investments, and more than the next two states combined. These numbers are not accidental. They are the result of

institutional reforms that place speed, accountability, and coordination at the heart of governance.

A crucial pillar of this transformation is the credibility of Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu. “Brand CBN” is not a slogan; it is an institutional asset built over decades. Corporates trust him because they know he brings long-standing relationships, a deep understanding of industry, and an unwavering commitment to seeing projects through. There is also a term that many in industry now use with a mix of respect and reassurance – “Naidugiri”. It reflects a simple truth: governments are not perfect, challenges arise, markets fluctuate, but Andhra Pradesh will stand by its investors, especially when times are tough.

Building for the Future

Looking ahead, the pace of change will

